Daily Content Intel

June 29, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, here's one that catches a lot of athletes off guard. You finish a hard lift, you're sore, and you hop straight in the cold tub because it feels great and you figure it's speeding up recovery. The problem is, when you do that right after lifting, you're turning down the exact signal that builds the muscle you just trained for.

When you lift, your body switches on a building response, and cold water immersion right after switches part of that response back off. In one study, the athletes who iced right after their sessions grew noticeably less type 2 muscle, the fast, powerful fibers you actually want for sprinting and contact. The strength still showed up. The size and the fast-fiber growth took the hit.

So here's what I tell my football and lacrosse guys. If your goal that day is getting bigger and more powerful, hold off on the ice bath right after the lift. Give it a few hours, or save the cold for a game day or a brutal in-season week when bouncing back fast matters more than building. Cold water is a tool, and timing is the whole game.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: That ice bath right after your lift might be quietly canceling the work you just did.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, here's one that catches a lot of athletes off guard. You finish a hard lift, you're sore, and you hop straight in the cold tub because it feels great and you figure it's speeding up recovery. The problem is, when you do that right after lifting, you're turning down the exact signal that builds the muscle you just trained for.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Ice bath right after lifting?
- 0:05 You might be canceling your gains
- 0:18 Lifting turns ON the build signal

- 0:24 Cold right after turns it back down
- 0:32 Less type 2 (fast, powerful) muscle
- 0:45 Strength held. Size took the hit.
- 0:52 Want to grow? Skip the cold post-lift
- 1:05 Save cold for game day / heavy in-season weeks
- 1:14 Cold is a tool. Timing is everything.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

The ice bath feels great after a hard lift. The timing might be costing you.

When you lift, your body turns on the signal that builds muscle. Jumping in cold water right after turns part of that signal back down, and the research shows it blunts fast-fiber (type 2) growth, the exact muscle you want for sprinting and contact. Strength still comes. Size and power growth take the hit.

So if the goal that day is getting bigger and more powerful, hold the cold for a few hours, or save it for game day and brutal in-season weeks when bouncing back fast matters more than building. Cold water is a tool. Timing is the whole game.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT Book: threshold.clientsecure.me

#footballtraining #lacrosse #strengthandconditioning #athletedevelopment #recovery #icebath #coldwaterimmersion #returntosport #strengthtraining #sportsperformance #thresholdhp

Personalize this

- Which of your HS football or lacrosse athletes ice the most, and how do you sequence cold work around their lifting days during an offseason hypertrophy block versus an in-season week?
- Have you had an athlete who lived in the cold tub and stalled on size or power gains, and how did you adjust their recovery once you saw it?
- How do you frame the difference between "build phase" recovery and "compete phase" recovery to a 16-year-old who just thinks the ice bath is making him better, and where does this fit your CROSS framework?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11235606/ | "Throwing cold water on muscle growth: A systematic review with meta■analysis of the effects of postexercise cold water immersion on resistance training■induced hypertrophy"
- physiology | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/31513450/ | "increases in type II muscle fiber cross-sectional area were attenuated with CWI (-1,959 ± 1,675 μM2 ; ES: -1.37 ± 0.99)"
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11235606/ | "individuals seeking to maximize muscle hypertrophy should avoid using CWI immediately following bouts of RT"

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11235606/
- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/31513450/

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take on a supplement claim making the rounds. There's a new review saying free essential amino acids, EAAs, can bypass the interference effect. That's the old idea that hard conditioning eats into your strength and size gains when you train both in the same block. Which, if you play football or lacrosse, is your entire life. You lift and you run, all year long.

And the mechanism is genuinely cool. The same amino acids feed the muscle-building side and the engine-building side at the same time, so in theory you stop the two from fighting each other.

Here's my problem. The headline result, that big 26% jump in endurance, comes from a mouse study. Zero human trials show EAAs erasing interference in athletes who actually lift and condition. The authors also hold patents on amino acid blends, so read it with that in mind.

So before you spend money on another tub of powder, do the boring stuff that already works. Lift heavy, keep your easy conditioning easy, go hard when it's time to go hard, and eat enough protein across the whole day. That's what protects your gains right now.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: A new review says the right amino acids let you lift and condition without the two canceling each other out. The receipt is a mouse.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take on a supplement claim making the rounds. There's a new review saying free essential amino acids, EAAs, can bypass the interference effect. That's the old idea that hard conditioning eats into your strength and size gains when you train both in the same block. Which, if you play football or lacrosse, is your entire life. You lift and you run, all year long.

And the mechanism is genuinely cool. The same amino acids feed the muscle-building side and the engine-building side at the same time, so in theory you stop the two from fighting each other.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 "EAAs bypass the interference effect"
- 0:06 (lift + condition without canceling gains)
- 0:14 If you play football or lax, this is your life
- 0:24 The mechanism IS cool...
- 0:32 ...but the 26% result is from a MOUSE
- 0:42 Zero human trials in lifting + conditioning athletes
- 0:48 Authors hold amino acid patents
- 0:56 Do the boring stuff that works:
- 1:02 Lift heavy. Easy stays easy. Hard stays hard.
- 1:10 Eat enough protein across the day

Caption (copy-paste ready):

A new review says free essential amino acids can "bypass" the interference effect, the idea that hard conditioning eats into your strength and size when you train both in the same block. If you play football or lacrosse, that's your whole year. You lift and you run.

The mechanism is cool: the same amino acids feed muscle building and the aerobic engine at once. But the headline 26% endurance result comes from a mouse study, there are zero human trials showing EAAs erase interference in athletes who lift and condition, and the authors hold patents on amino acid blends.

Before you buy another tub of powder, do the boring stuff that already works. Lift heavy. Keep easy conditioning easy. Go hard when it's time. Eat enough protein across the day. That's what protects your gains right now.

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#footballtraining #lacrosse #strengthandconditioning #concurrenttraining #EAAs #aminoacids #sportsnutrition #athletedevelopment #supplements #returntosport #thresholdhp

Personalize this

- How do you actually structure concurrent training (lift + conditioning) for your in-season football and lacrosse athletes so the two don't blunt each other, without reaching for a supplement to fix it?

- What's your standing answer when an athlete or parent asks whether they should buy EAAs or amino acid powders, and where do you draw the line between "worth it" and "save your money"?
- How do you talk about protein timing and daily total with your athletes, and what does "fuel like an adult" look like for a 16-year-old playing two sports?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11446676/ | "Free essential amino acid feeding improves endurance during resistance training via DRP1■dependent mitochondrial remodelling"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11446676/ | "EAA + RET also increased endurance capacity more than RET alone (26%, P < 0.05) by increasing both mitochondrial protein synthesis (53%, P < 0.05) and DRP1 activation (P < 0.05)."

Sources:

- https://www.mdpi.com/2072-6643/18/12/1990
- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11446676/

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Blood flow restriction for in-season muscle maintenance and return-to-sport in load-compromised athletes (strong 2024-2025 meta-analyses; very practical for football/lacrosse rehab).
- Low energy availability / RED-S and bone stress injury risk in adolescent athletes (DXA Z-score < -1 linked to high-risk site injuries) — fueling/durability teaching angle.
- Velocity-based training / autoregulation for managing in-season vs offseason loading.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (newsletter_digest_2026-06-29.pdf): mostly Mike T. Nelson content. Lead finding = a new Nutrients 2026 review (Jang, Wolfe, & Kim) claiming free EAAs can "bypass" the resistance/endurance interference effect, with Mike himself flagging that the receipt is a mouse study and the authors hold EAA patents. Also Dr. Mercola promo (skipped, pure promo + supplement clearance), and an EAA podcast (Angelo Keely / Kion, affiliate — skipped as promo).

- PubMed / PMC: cold water immersion vs resistance-training hypertrophy — strong cluster of primary sources (2024 meta-analysis "Throwing cold water on muscle growth"; 2019 JAP fiber-CSA mechanism study). Picked for Draft A.
- PubMed / PMC: blood flow restriction in-season athletes (good runner-up, several 2024-2025 meta-analyses), low energy availability / RED-S bone stress injury in adolescents (good runner-up, athlete-relevant). Held for next time.
- NSCA / BJSM / JOSPT: no fresh standout this cycle beyond what the CWI + EAA picks already cover.
- Dedup check against `cited-sources.json` (48 entries): CWI and EAA-interference topic families are both absent from the last 90 days. Recent registry covers sprint/sled, creatine, hamstring/Nordic,

plyometrics, sleep, eccentric RTS, stretching, SAQ agility, keto, knee OA, per-meal protein. Both picks are clean.